

Strategy Brief #6

Land Use Change & Urban Expansion in Rapidly Growing Deltas



Analysing how uncontrolled urban expansion into flood-prone and ecologically sensitive delta areas is driving environmental degradation, threatening food security, and inflating future infrastructure adaptation costs.

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Introduction

Deltas are among the fastest-growing regions globally, driven by **urbanisation, economic opportunities, and population growth.**



Key Challenge

Uncontrolled land-use changes are increasing **environmental degradation and exposure to hazards.**

Strategic Insights

- Urban expansion often occurs in **flood-prone and unstable areas.**
- Natural ecosystems are being **rapidly converted or degraded.**
- Planning frameworks are often **reactive and fragmented.**



Strategic Implications

- Increased risk of **flooding and environmental collapse.**
- Long-term threats to **food security and livelihoods.**
- Rising costs for **infrastructure and adaptation.**



Recommendations

- Strengthen **integrated land-use planning**.
- Protect critical ecosystems (wetlands, floodplains).
- Promote **sustainable urban development models**.
- Improve coordination between **sectors and institutions**.



Value Proposition

Better land-use planning ensures **balanced development and long-term resilience**.